



Q

What acidity percentage should vinegar have to safely pickle vegetables at home?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

5% acidity vinegar

FUN FACT

Using 5% acidity vinegar stops dangerous bacteria like Clostridium botulinum from growing.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Why should the blossom end of cucumbers be cut off before pickling?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

It contains enzymes that can soften the pickles

FUN FACT

Cutting off just 1/16 inch of the blossom end improves pickle texture.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What metal utensils should NOT be used when pickling because they can react with acid or salt?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Zinc, copper, brass, galvanized metal, or iron

FUN FACT

Using reactive metal can cause changes in color and safety of your pickles.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the role of salt in fermenting vegetables like sauerkraut or kimchi?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

It helps control bacterial growth and creates a firm texture

FUN FACT

Salt also helps good lactic acid bacteria grow during fermentation.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How long should cucumbers soak in pickling lime water to get firm pickles?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

12 to 24 hours with several rinses

FUN FACT

Pickling lime makes pickles crisp but must be rinsed well before pickling.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Which type of salt is recommended for pickling brine to get the best results?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Canning or pickling salt

FUN FACT

Some salts have additives that cloud the brine or add impurities, so pickling salt is best.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the minimum headspace to leave in jars when packing vegetables hot for pickling?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

1/2 inch headspace

FUN FACT

Leaving the right headspace helps vacuum seals form during processing.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

Q

What temperature method is used to safely process jars of pickles to prevent spoilage?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Boiling water canning

FUN FACT

Boiling water canning times vary by altitude to ensure safety.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What happens if you reduce the amount of vinegar in a pickling recipe?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

The acidity may be too low to prevent harmful bacteria

FUN FACT

Never reduce vinegar concentration in tested recipes for safety.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Why must fermented pickles be kept under the brine during fermentation?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To keep them away from air to prevent mold

FUN FACT

A weight is used to keep vegetables submerged in the salty water.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

Q

What is a common acid besides vinegar used to help safely pickle mushrooms?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Bottled lemon juice

FUN FACT

Lemon juice helps keep mushrooms safe and adds flavor in pickling.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How long should cucumbers be stored after processing to develop ideal flavor for firm pickles?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

4 to 5 weeks

FUN FACT

Pickles keep improving in texture and taste as they age in jars.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the standard vinegar acidity recommended for all quick pickling recipes?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

5% acidity

FUN FACT

5% vinegar acidity is a reliable safety level for home pickling.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Which vegetable size is best to select for making dill pickles?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

3- to 4-inch cucumbers

FUN FACT

Smaller cucumbers generally make crisper, better-textured pickles.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

Why should you not use reduced-sodium salt in fermented pickles like sauerkraut?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Because sodium controls bacterial growth and texture in fermentation

FUN FACT

Salt amount is critical for successful fermentation safety and quality.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How is pickling salt different from table salt for home pickling?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

It is pure salt without additives that cloud brine

FUN FACT

Pure pickling salt keeps brine clear and pickle texture firm.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

Q

What happens during the fermenting process of vegetables like kimchi or sauerkraut?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

Lactic acid bacteria produce acid that preserves the vegetables

FUN FACT

Fermentation takes several weeks but creates unique flavors and safety.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What is the role of sugar in sweet pickle recipes?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

To balance the acidity and add sweetness

FUN FACT

Sugar and vinegar balance flavor but sugar is not a preservative by itself.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

What type of container is recommended for fermenting large batches of pickles at home?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

**Food-grade stoneware crock
or glass container**

FUN FACT

*Using the right container keeps
fermentation safe and tasty.*

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables



Q

How should jars be prepared before filling with pickles for canning?

PICKLING



Teens (14–18)

ANSWER

They should be hot and sterilized

FUN FACT

Hot sterilized jars help prevent contamination during processing.

Source: PNW 355 Pickling vegetables